Milan Aleksić

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Personal

Born on 21/12/1983, Smederevo (Serbia), living in Koekelberg (Belgium) with my wife and children since 2011. I hold dual citizenship of Belgium and Serbia.

My website is aleksic.dev, email is milan@aleksic.dev and Twitter account is: milanaleksic. I am fairly active on github.com/milanaleksic. My LinkedIn account is @milanaleksic if you'd like to connect with me.

Education & spoken languages

Dipl. Ing. Computer Science & Engineering (2008) from the *University of Belgrade* (Serbia), Faculty of Electrical Engineering (ETF). "NARIC – Vlaanderen" recognized my diploma as M.Sc..

I speak the following languages: **Serbian** (mother tongue), **English** (fluent), **Dutch** (C1 Effectiveness 1), **French** (A2, basic level)

Keywords

Java, Go, AWS, Python, PostgreSQL, MySQL, ClickHouse

Work experience

[2026-...] Staff Software Engineer @ Soda (remote; HQ in Brussels, Belgium)

Led architectural changes and AI adoption to support rapid ARR growth and drive Product & Engineering deliverables through my role in the platform team. Some examples of hands-on work done: cross-team framework standardization, introduction of new services, guidance for effective usage of LLMs, etc.

Increased internal developer velocity by creating `spritz` (a local E2E development platform) and `chain` (an agentic development system with autonomous PR/CI/CD management and background ticket/review control planes, basically "factory with lights on").

[2020-2026] Senior Software Engineer @ Soda (remote; HQ in Brussels, Belgium)

Backend founding engineer of Soda, working on Soda Cloud SaaS. Programming languages I used were Java, Python and Go. I became the company's go-to backend engineer and MySQL performance guy. Helped scale the company 100x in both customers and revenue during my tenure in Soda.

Some of the most prominent backend features I worked on were internal frameworks for authorization, feature gates, notification rules, database and search query framework, dependency injection, configuration management, OpenAPI code generator, etc. I also participated in the development of many of Soda critical architecture components beside backend: Decrypter, Guardian, Soda Kubernetes Agent, introduction of ClickHouse etc. I also envisioned and developed an internal devops CLI tool in Go (`dogo`) integrating APIs from AWS, Okta, Datadog, Kubernetes, Soda Cloud Admin API, Github.

[2017-2020] Expert Software Engineer @ TomTom (Ghent, Belgium)

I worked in role of Expert Java Developer in 2 teams: MPU Core Coverage Creation & Extension Team and later in Hermes team which was creating the first steps in integrating OpenStreetMap in TomTom.

- *MLF library*: authored code-generated Java wrapper around GDAL OpenFileGDB (later extended to PostGIS and GeoPackage).
  - Custom ANTLR grammar for extended validation and Python/Markdown doc generator
- *Sinatra*: Led migration of a complex process into AWS for GIS source data digestion

  - PostgreSQL RDS, Spring Boot 2, SQS, ECS, Terraform, Vue.js
- *Pupin*: created machine learning cloud service for data classification (plural junctions problem)
  - Training: PostGIS, Python, Scikit-Learn, XGBoost, (Geo)Pandas, Jupyter and inference on AWS ECS and XGBoost
- *Dumbo*: migration of internal heavily used batch processing tool into the cloud
  - AWS Batch, ECS, PostgreSQL, S3, X-Ray; Spring Boot 2, Terraform, Python, Jenkins
- *Nozem*: always-up-to-date OpenStreetMap ingestion service into core TomTom data layer: Kafka, PostgreSQL, Python, Spring Boot, Jenkins
- *Lego*: automated OpenStreetMap features ingestion: k8s, Python, Java, QGIS plugins

[2013-2017] {Senior, Lead} Software Engineer @ Basware (Aalst, Belgium)

Projects:

- *Basware Network Portal*: Full-stack development role on online and internal services
  - Tech stack: Play2, Scala, Java8, MongoDB, Spring, Chef, Go
  - Rewritten core validation business rules implementation (Java)
- *Basware e-Archiving*: greenfield AWS serverless project based on Java Lambda functions, API GW, DynamoDB, SQS and CloudFormation
- *Norsu* (Groovy, Cucumber, Gradle): Cross-systems end-to-end testing
- Business Metrics dashboards (Akka and Dashing.io)
- Migration of legacy Resin applications to a Tomcat cluster
- *HAL9000* (Go): Flowdock bot (CI/CD automation helper for 100+ developers)

[2006-2013] Previous work experience

Reach out for a chat if you'd like more details about anything listed here.

2014: Freelance Consultant (remote) @ Gtech UK (*Brussels, Belgium*)

2011-2013: Software consultant @ Cronos (Belgium) (*Brussels, Belgium*)

2009-2011: Software Engineer II @ Gtech G2 Sports Betting (*Belgrade, Serbia*)

2007-2009: Java Developer @ Arius (*Belgrade, Serbia*)

2006: Intern software developer @ ESAProjekt (*Katowice, Poland*)

Selected open source projects

- **Advent of Code 2023** (Zig): github.com/milanaleksic/adventofcode2023
- **Advent of Code 2018** (Go): github.com/milanaleksic/adventofcode2018
- **Personal Web site** (Hugo, Cloudflare Pages): github.com/milanaleksic/aleksic.dev

Selected closed source personal projects

- **Home Laboratory**: Hybrid cluster: ARM/AMD, Proxmox LXCs/metal, home/Oracle Cloud. Uses Ansible for setup and Kubernetes (k3s) for container scheduling of 40+ services. Deep monitoring via Grafana Stack and Prometheus. Migrated away from Nomad in 2025.
- **Thought Train** (Go, PostgreSQL, NATS, htmx) My main side project – a distributed service for feature-rich web page content extraction, note-taking, and book annotation. Uses an ANTLR search query grammar, R2 as object storage, with mobile apps (Flutter for Android/iOS), and a Chrome Extension (Svelte).
- **Novinarnica** (Go): Content crawler and CBR packager for magazines.
- **kube-home-dns** (Go): k8s controller that is at the same time a home DNS server, a NextDNS forwarder, a Cloudflare DNS record syncer and a Caddy config provider for my k8s-free DMZ ingress